

Due tuesday, February 6th, noon.

This is the first problem set. Please present clean drawings/sketches wherever relevant, and show all calculations up to reasonable detail.

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1. (a) [**1+1 pts.**] Look up and report the values of the *permittivity of free space*,  $\epsilon_0$ , and the *permeability of free space*,  $\mu_0$ , in SI units. Include the units of each quantity.  
  
(b) [**2 pts.**] Look up and report Coulomb's law in SI units and in CGS units.
  
2. We will ignore the  $z$  direction for this problem. Consider the following points on the  $x$ - $y$  plane: the point  $A$  with coordinates  $(0, a)$ , the point  $B$  with coordinates  $(0, -a)$ , and the point  $P$  with coordinates  $(r, 0)$ .  
  
(a) [**6 pts.**] A particle at point  $P$  feels two forces, both of equal magnitude  $F_0$ . One force points in the direction from  $A$  towards  $P$  (along the direction  $AP$ ), and the other acts towards  $B$  (along the direction  $PB$ ). Find the total force acting on the particle.  
Reminder: Finding a vector means finding both its magnitude and its direction!!  
  
(b) [**6 pts.**] Imagine two vectors, each having the same magnitude  $E_0$ , acting on point  $P$ . One points from  $P$  towards  $A$  (along the direction  $PA$ ), and the other points from  $P$  towards  $B$  (along the direction  $PB$ ). Find the result of adding the two vectors.
  
3. [**7 pts.**] A thin glass rod lies along the  $x$ -axis, with one end at the origin and one end at the point  $(L, 0, 0)$ . The rod is charged non-uniformly. The linear charge density is  $\lambda = 4\gamma x^3$ . What is the total charge on the rod?  
Note: the linear charge density is the charge per unit length. Here  $\gamma$  is a constant.

4. [8 pts.] A flat square plate lies parallel to the  $x$ - $y$  plane and is charged with a variable surface charge density,  $\sigma = 2\gamma(xy + x^2)$ . (Here  $\gamma$  is a constant.) The four corners of the square plate are at the points  $(0, 0, z_0)$ ,  $(L, 0, z_0)$ ,  $(0, L, z_0)$ ,  $(L, L, z_0)$ . What is the total charge on the plate?

Note: the surface charge density is the charge per unit area.

5. [4 pts.] The electric field in some region is given by

$$\mathbf{E} = \frac{V_0}{d} (5xy\hat{i} + 2z^2\hat{j})$$

where  $\hat{i}$  and  $\hat{j}$  are unit vectors in the  $x$  and  $y$  directions, and  $V_0$  and  $d$  are positive constants. Find the force experienced by a charge  $q$  that is placed at the point  $(x, y, z) = (d, -d, d)$ .

6. [7 pts.] The closed curve  $C$  lies in the  $x$ - $y$  plane and encloses area  $\alpha$ . Using Stokes' theorem, calculate the line integral of the vector field

$$\mathbf{T} = -2y\hat{i} + 2x\hat{j}$$

around the curve  $C$ .

7. Here  $L$  and  $d$  are positive distances, with  $d > L$ . Also,  $Q$  and  $q$  are positive charges.

- (a) [5 pts.] Five point charges are placed on the  $x$ -axis, at the points with  $x$ -coordinates  $L/5$ ,  $2L/5$ ,  $3L/5$ ,  $4L/5$  and  $L$ . Each of these carry the charge  $Q/5$ .

A point charge  $q$  is placed, also on the  $x$ -axis, at the point  $(d, 0, 0)$ . Find the total force experienced by the charge  $q$ .

- (b) [3 pts.] Consider the limit  $d \gg L$ . Simplify your expression for this limit, and explain your result physically.